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osFinancials5.1.0.269 – UI-Design – Checkbox alignment - Outstanding

UI Design [] Checkboxes fixed in osFinancials5.1.0.286

Corrected '[] Text' Alignment of Checkboxes fixed in osFinancials5.1.0.286

Open Set of Books

Registration

User tab

Bank recon (old)

Open item

Calendar (all options/appointments)

Setup -> Accounts

Setup -> Documents

Setup -> Reporting dates

Setup -> Access control

Setup -> Printer

Setup - Export

Setup - Import

Tools -> Customize languages

Tools -> Data integrity check

Global processes -> Reverse posted document

Input -> Confirm (Quotes and Orders)

Stock items (Advanced mode tabs - Import / Export + Adjust stock tabs)

Central Search

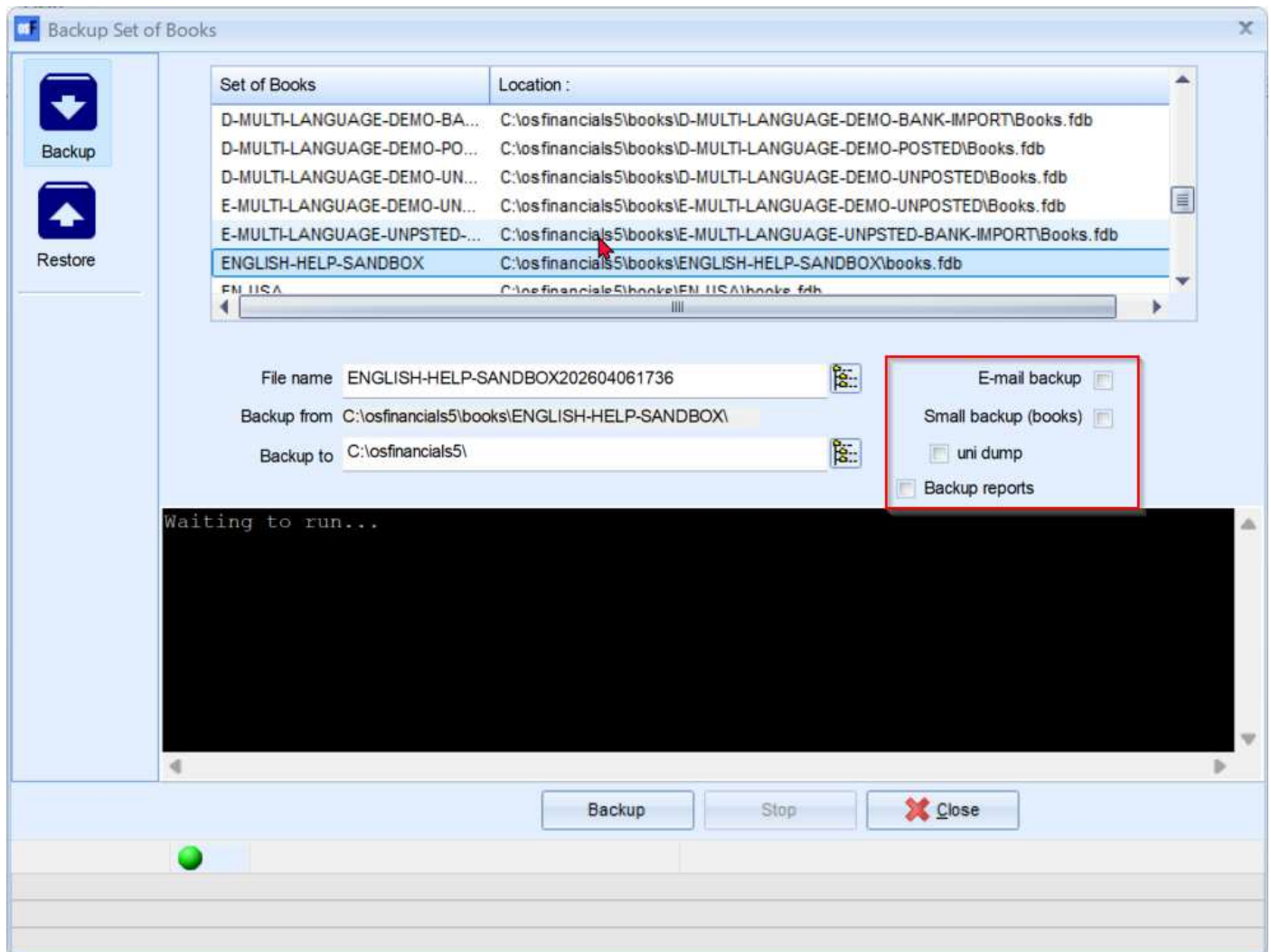
Ledger analyser

Age analysis (Reports ribbon)

Batch setup (Standard and Advanced tabs)

Incorrect aligned 'Text []' Alignment of Checkboxes fixed in
osFinancials5.1.0.286

Backup/Restore (both options)



Setup -> Stock info

Stock information

Default Units Tax classes

Selling price descriptions

Selling price 1	Selling price 1
Selling price 2	Selling price 2
Selling price 3	Selling price 3
Default	Selling price1

Cost of sales

Create cost of sales ☒

Cost of sales batch Cost of sales

Use ☒ Average cost ☐ Latest cost

- Production Contra account: T- Empty

Documents setup

Setup options

☐ SQL only for stock lookup

☐ Merge invoice to orders

☐ Merge items per tax on ledger

☐ Calculate BOM stock

☐ Warning Backorders

☐ Limit stock purchase only for default supplier or non

☐ Force stock type check

☐ No calc for backorders to deliver

☐ No calc for qty unposted

Default inclusive for documents ☐

Cannot edit price ☐

Cannot edit description ☐

Go to quantity ☐

No backorder ☐

Cannot sell out of stock ☐

Use tabs in stock ☒

No print confirmation ☐

Check reference used ☐

Cannot create items ☐

Button lookup ☐

No out of stock message ☒

Use colours for out of stock ☐

Do not focus last doc ☐

OK Close

Setup -> Data parameters

System Parameters

Report amounts with

☐ <> for Credit

☒ +/- for Debit/Credit

☐ D/C for Debit/Credit

Data storage

☐ Real numbers

☒ Fixed decimals 2

Reporting decimals

Number 2

Document row 2

Document quantity 2

Document show quantity 2

DateTime settings

Speed

Do not calculate batches ☐

Use currency sign ☐

Dutch text numbering ☐

Special settings

Show calendar ☒

Manual bank reconciliation ☒

Contra ref. as account ref. ☐

Strict tax on account ☐

Enable Blockchain ☐

Projects ☐

Enable auto set inactive debtor after x days unpaid ☐

General ledger differences

T- Empty

Log level

OK

Cancel

Setup -> POS

Radio buttons - move to left

Setup -> POS - Peripherals - Drawer

The screenshot shows the 'POS setup' window with the 'Peripherals' tab selected. A red arrow points to the 'Peripherals' tab. The 'Drawer' sub-tab is active. The 'Port' section has a red box around the 'Parallel port' and 'Serial port' radio buttons, with 'Serial port' selected. The 'Port number' is set to '1'. The 'Open cash drawer for' section has a blue box around the 'Cheques', 'Credit Cards', and 'Vouchers' checkboxes, all of which are checked. The 'Serial port parameters' section shows 'Baud rate' as 9600, 'Data bits' as 8, 'Stop bits' as 1, and 'Parity' as N. The 'Control String' is set to '07'. A 'Test' button is located below the 'Control String' dropdown. A blue box highlights the 'Drawer connected' checkbox, which is currently unchecked. At the bottom right, there are 'OK' and 'Close' buttons.

POS setup

Settings Entry **Peripherals** Printer

Drawer Pole display Barcode Scanner Weight dish

Port

Parallel port ☐

Serial port ☒

Port number 1

Open cash drawer for

☒ Cheques

☒ Credit Cards

☒ Vouchers

Serial port parameters

Baud rate 9600

Data bits 8

Stop bits 1

Parity N

Control String 07

☐ Drawer connected

Test

OK Close

Setup -> POS - Pole display tab

POS setup

Settings Entry **Peripherals** Printer

Drawer Pole display Barcode Scanner Weight dish

Port

Parallel port ☒

Serial port ☐

Port number

Test Message

Can you see this ??

Serial port parameters

Baud rate

Data bits

Stop bits

Parity

☐ Pole display connected

Test

OK Close

Lookups

Setup -> Stock info - Select production account and all lookups in reports, etc. is incorrectly aligned to 'Text []' in Search by fields.

Also incorrect in Select Stock item lookup screens

Select account

Code Code Search

None Clear

Use your mouse to pull a column here to group on that column

Code	Description
T	Empty
G010000	Sales
G100000	Cost of sales
G205000	Depreciation
G210000	Motor vehicle expenses
G210010	Fuel and oil
G210020	Maintenance
G210030	Repairs
G215000	Maintenance of tools
G220000	Rent
G225000	Salaries and wages
G230000	Stationery
G235000	Sundry expenses
G505000	Capital
G510000	Retained income
G520000	Installment agreements
G600000	Furniture & fittings - Net value

Search by

Code ☒ Description ☐ Auto-select ☐

NOTE - Fast add item in documents is correctly aligned as '[] Text' in Search by fields.

* (011)314-9997 1ABGRE Invoice IN000022 Mr. AB Green, 3.00 items on hand..

Code		Search	Stock group 1
None	☐ Inactive	Clear	Power tools
	☐ multilang		Stock group 2

Code	Description	Barcode	Extra description
3DRILL	Drill press	1234567890	850 Watts + 6 drill b
4L-INSTCUP	Install - Built-in cupboards		
4L-PAINT-E	Paint - Exterior		
BOM	BOM		
BOMPRODUCTIC	BOM (Production)		
GL-CODE	General ledger		
OPTIONITEM	Option item		
OPTIONITEM-NS	Option item (no stock)		
SALES	Sales		

Search by :

☒ Code ☐ Description ☐ Barcode ☐ Auto-select

Cur : 9 Quote : 3 Order : 0 Exp : 6 P1 : 1000(1150) P2 : 1100(1265) P3 : 1200(1380) LP : 500(575)

Stock items

New	Stock code	3COMP	Change code	Apply invoice discount ☒
Delete	Description	Compressor		Disabled ☐
Edit	Expected quantity	Cur : 1 Quote : 2 Order : 0 Exp : -1		
Save	Stock information			
Cancel	Barcode	3456789123	Extra description	
Copy from item	Manufacturer	CMP		
Default	Type	Default		
	Units	Each		
	Reports			
	Stock group 1	Power tools		
	Stock group 2	Unallocated		
	Preferred supplier 1	C2AO-NES A-ONE Suppliers	Preferred supplier 2	C2BE-STS BEST Suppliers
	Supplier stock code	A1-12345	Supplier stock code	B-12345
	Ledges			
	Document groups Transactions Image Multi-group Backorders			
	Tax class Standard rate 15%			
	Selling prices			
	Excl. amt. Incl. amt.			
	Selling price 1 1500 1725.00			
	Selling price 2 1600 1840.00			
	Selling price 3 1700 1955.00			
	Value			
	Average cost 960			
	Total cost 4800.00			
	Quantity on hand 5			
	Latest cost 1000.00			

Use barcode printer

Single line mode

Update type

All

NoCalcFields

Image

Debtors / Creditors

Debtors - Accounting information tab / Creditors - Accounting information tab

Account disabled

Open item account

Use default tax account

Use default tax

New Delete Edit Save Cancel Export	Debtor code	1ABGRE	Phone 1	(011)314-9997
	Name	Mr. AB Green	Phone 2	(011)314-9998
	Address	PO Box 1111	Fax	(011)314-9999
	Postal code	2122	Website	
	Address 2	Lakeside	E-mail	green@pinksoft.co.za
	Address 3	Johannesburg	Tax reference	11111111
	Country	Empty	Company reg. no.	22222222
	Contactperson	Andrew Green	Debtor group 1	Debtor group 1C
	Salesperson	Russell	Debtor group 2	Unallocated
			Language	English
Delivery address Accounting information Contacts Appointment Documents Transactions Bank accounts Backorders Stock				
Account disabled Open item account		Bank account type	Arbitrair	Signature
Due days 30		Bank account no.		Signature Date
Credit limit 30000		Bank name		1899/12/30
Charge amount 0		BIC		
Customer discount 0 %		IBAN		
Monthly interest on overdue amounts 0 %				
Selling price Selling price 1		Use default account		
		Use default tax		

New Delete Edit Save Cancel Export	Creditor code	2AONES	Phone 1	(011) 838-9221
	Name	A-ONE Suppliers	Phone 2	(011) 838-9222
	Address	P O Box 31318	Fax	(011) 838-9223
	Postal code	2000	Website	turbocash.net
	Address 2	Marshalltown	E-mail	aones@pinksoft.co.za
	Address 3	Johannesburg	Tax reference	906012345
	Country	South Africa	Company reg. no.	123459060
	Contactperson	Mr. Andy Austin	Creditor group 1	Creditor group 1B
			Creditor group 2	Unallocated
			Language	English
Delivery address Accounting information Contacts Appointment Documents Transactions Bank accounts Stock				
Account disabled Open item account		Bank account type	Arbitrair	Signature
Due days 30		Bank account no.		Signature Date
Credit limit 12000		Bank name		1899/12/30
Charge amount 10		BIC		
		IBAN		
		Use default account		
		Use default tax		
		Debtor code		

UI Modernization: The Case for Left-Aligned Checkboxes

THE PROBLEM: LEGACY 'SCATTERED' LAYOUTS



THE 'EXAM MARK' STYLE

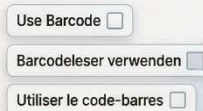
Users perceive the checkbox as a result or a validation mark rather than a prompt for interaction, making the UI feel like a fill-in-the-blank test.



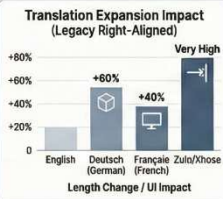
THE "ZIG-ZAG" SCAN & F-SHAPED PATTERN BROKEN

Inconsistency with left-aligned Radio Buttons increases cognitive load. Users must hunt across the screen, breaking their natural 'F-shaped' scanning pattern.

INTERNATIONALIZATION (i18n) FAILURE



Moving the box to the left allows translated text to expand infinitely to the right without hitting the control.



SOLUTION & BENCHMARKS: UNIVERSAL LEFT-ALIGNMENT

THE MODERN STANDARD ([] Label)



Research into 'Reading Gravity' shows users scan the left margin first to see both the option and its state (checked/unchecked) in one glance.

INDUSTRY LEADERS & THE 'ACTION LINE'



THE TECHNICAL & PSYCHOLOGY 'WHY' & ROADMAP

THE 'VERB RULE' & FITT'S LAW

Use Barcode ☐ **Verb Rule**
Drop redundant action verbs to save 20-40% horizontal space. In the [] Label format, the box is the verb.



Fitt's Law Advantage
Left-alignment creates a straight vertical 'Action Line'. Placing interactive targets in a predictable vertical line allows faster acquisition with less mouse movement.

IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

PRIORITY MODULE REMEDIATION
Update high-traffic screens first (Batch Options, Stock Setup, Debtors/Creditors) for immediate impact.

DOCUMENTATION STRATEGY
Use 'Change-Focused' documentation. Provide 'Before/After' visuals and update text to focus on the goal, not position.

THE 'CORRECT WRAPPED STANDARD'
For exceptionally long translations, ensure the second line of text is indented to maintain a clean vertical line for the checkboxes.

NotebookLM

Modernizing UI: The Case for Left-Aligned Checkboxes

THE PROBLEM: LEGACY RIGHT-ALIGNMENT

The "Exam Mark" Style
Legacy systems often place the checkboxes after the label, making the UI feel like a fill-in-the-blank test rather than an interactive tool.

The "Canyon" Effect
Developers often set checkboxes far to the right to accommodate the longest possible translation, creating a massive, disconnected gap for English users.

The Zig-Zag Scan
When radio buttons are on the left but checkboxes are on the right, users are forced to hunt across the screen for different interactive elements.

THE SOLUTION: UNIVERSAL LEFT-ALIGNMENT



The [] Label Standard
Aligning the interactive box to the left of the text is the established "DNK" of modern software design used by Microsoft Office, LibreOffice, and Xero.

105 SUPPORTED LANGUAGES
Latin, Араби, Сулики, мий, الطيقم, 中英话, Zulu

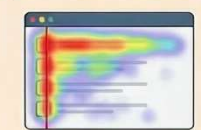
105 Supported Languages
Standardizing left-alignment is the only way to reliably support the expansion of 105+ translation files (from Afrikaans to Zulu) without breaking the UI.

English: ☐ Barcode
Deutsch: ☐ Barcodeleser verwenden
Français: ☐ Utiliser le code-barres

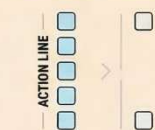
The "Verb" Space Saver
☐ Use Barcode Printer
☐ Barcode Printer
20-40% Space Saved

The "Verb" Space Saver
Left-alignment allows you to drop redundant verbs, for example, "Use Barcode Printer" becomes simply "Barcode Printer", saving 20-40% of horizontal space.

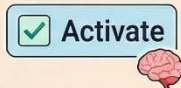
WHY IT WORKS: SCANNABILITY & PSYCHOLOGY



F-Shaped Reading Pattern
Users scan down the left margin first, placing the checkbox there allows them to see the option and its state (checked/unchecked) in a single glance.



Fitt's Law Advantage
Creating a straight vertical "Action Line" of targets on the left reduces the distance a user must move their mouse, making the software less physically tiring to use.

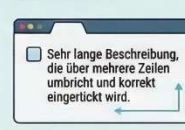


Affordance and Intent
A checkbox at the start acts as a prompt to "activate" the following text, whereas a box at the end feels like a review or verification element.

TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE



Establish a Fixed Anchor
Set all checkboxes to a consistent horizontal coordinate (e.g., Left + 8) so the "Action Line" remains perfectly vertical across all tabs.



Enable WordWrap
For long translations (like German or Shona), set **Label WordWrap** to True and indent the second line to align with the text, not the box.



Link Focus Controls
Ensure the **Label FocusControl** property is linked to the **CheckBox** so that clicking the text toggles the box - essential for touch-device accessibility.

NotebookLM